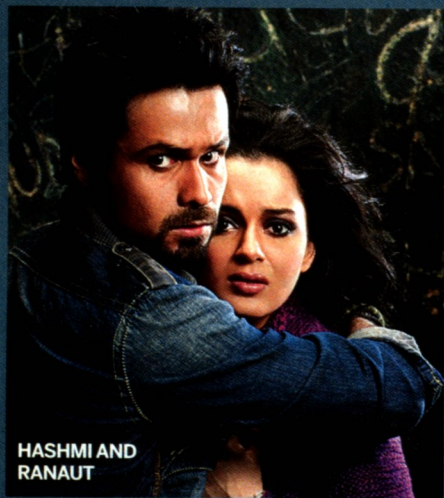


FILM REVIEW

RAAZ: THE MYSTERY CONTINUES

Skin and Sin



HASHMI AND RANAUT

Director: Mohit Suri

Starring: Emraan Hashmi,
Kangna Ranaut

Mohit Suri has mastered the Bhatt Factory formula of skin, sin, sensation, and yes, sex on parapets. In *Raaz: The Mystery Continues*, he takes the staples of the horror genre and does the creaking doors, whistling pressure cookers, barking dogs and flickering candles well. He also tries to give it a contemporary twist by delving into the

horror within. Just as the first *Raaz* revolved around the theme of Savitri and Satyavan, this one focuses on the evil that lies in all of us. Here it is greed. *Sach ko becho, khwab kharido* (sell the truth and buy dreams). A couple has everything and wants more, so strange things start happening to them. *Tum ashudh ho; sadh chuke ho* (you are impure, you have rotted from within) pops up everywhere, written in blood. She, Kangna Ranaut, flies like *Iron Man*, speaks in odd voices and goes head to head with a herd of bison. He, Adhyayan Suman, is just a heel, apart from being a non-believer. Emraan Hashmi is the outsider, who paints as furiously as he scowls, turning his back on his father only to find in him a saviour. But umm, don't look too deep for meaning despite the mumbo jumbo, a lot of the Bhagvad Gita and a bit of the Last Supper. This is a movie that provides cheap thrills with a touch of sophistication.

by Kaveree Bamzai

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

MUSIC REVIEW

Timeless APPEAL

GEETMALA KI
CHHAON MEIN
SARE GAMA
Rs 545

Few radio programmes have enjoyed as iconic a status as that of Ameen Sayani's *Geetmala*. His melodious voice still rings loud and clear in the ears of millions. Even 50 years later, requests

for Sayani's *Geetmala* continue unabated. *Geetmala Ki Chhaon Mein* brings back the beloved *apka radio dost* in an album of five volumes. It features gems of Hindi film music from the 1930s-50s. The repertoire is interwoven with interviews of yesteryear stars such as Kishore Kumar and Sunil Dutt. Sayani takes the listeners through the bylanes of film music in his inimitable style, sharing milestones from the *Geetmala* phenomenon. It is a tribute to the flood of requests, almost 60,000 letters a week, over the years. The magic is alive.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

RAJA RAVI VARMA AS
SEEN BY ROHIT CHAWLA

ART EXHIBITIONS

Ferns and Petals

For over 150 years, Raja Ravi Varma's paintings have captured the imagination of filmmakers, artistes, photographers and designers. What was remarkable was that he taught himself art. Fashion photographer Rohit Chawla pays a photographic tribute to

A PIECE BY LEON



Varma by launching a limited edition calendar. In Delhi, the exhibition opens at the Visual Art Gallery,

from February 2 to 5.

Two artistes from Kerala present an exhibition titled *Earth Beneath*. Sebastian Varghese and Leon K.L. explore different facets of plant life. The imagery of both originate from their environment and a necessity to connect with the world around. Sebastian's watercolours explore an intricate world of flora and Leon's soft pastels depict diverse forms of plant life. From January 28 to February 18, at Gallery Threshold, Delhi.